



1770

Frock coat The frock coat was characterized by a folded-over collar, narrow sleeves without a turn-back cuff, and a slim silhouette, often with a curving front. It was a sombre-toned wool cloth garment, with blue-black a popular choice.



1775

Chiné robe This sack back style is in the newly popular chiné print. The pattern was printed on to the warp thread prior to weaving, giving a fuzzy effect known in this era as chiné in France and "clouds" in England.



1778

Overcoat Another new style for men in the 18th century (as well as the frock coat), the overcoat, or redingote, was derived from English working men's dress. This French example was worn as a walking coat over a close-cut suit.



1786

Morning walk Gainsborough was the leading English society portrait painter in the later 18th century. Depicted here is a newly wed couple, who wear the height of English fashionable dress, copied throughout Europe at this time.



Rustic style German writer Goethe relaxes in an informal, cream linen or cotton overgarment in this 1787 portrait by the artist Tischbein. There is no visible shaping to this simple, country-style cloak, just an opening for the neck.